

Buddy
for Q2 Pod

A mini-guide to the app · version 1.2.1

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Getting Started 1

Install Buddy and say hello.

Buddy

Library → **Games** → **Buddy** is a ghost to poke, pet and fling around the screen. Turn on Tamagotchi and you raise it from an egg instead, or paint your own and Buddy shows that in place of the ghost (Chapter 3). It isn't in the firmware: it runs from the microSD card.

Installing Buddy

You need Q2 Pod 1.6.3 or later. The easy way is over Wi-Fi: open **System settings** → **App Store** and press Centre on **Buddy**.

Or by hand:

1. Download `fidget.zip` from github.com/DiamondBond/q2-fidget/releases/latest.
2. Plug the Q2 into your computer with the USB-C cable. The card shows up as a drive.
3. Unzip the file to the card's root, so the card has a `.fidget` folder. On macOS and Linux the leading dot hides the folder; Cmd+Shift+. shows it in Finder.
4. Eject and unplug the Q2.

Playing with Buddy

To	Do this
Make it giggle	Tap its tummy
Boop it	Tap its face
Pet it	Hold a finger on it
Pick it up and fling it	Drag it, then let go
Annoy it	Tap it five times quickly
Make it dizzy	Spin the wheel fast
Make it say boo	Press Centre
Open the menu	Press Return
Close Buddy at once	Hold Return



Petted



Boo

Play/Pause and the side buttons keep controlling the music. Leave Buddy alone and it dozes off. After two minutes without a touch it closes, unless **Smart Awake** is on (**System settings** → **Display**), which keeps it open and the screen lit.

The menu

Press **Return**. Turn the wheel and press Centre, or tap a row.



The menu

- **Continue:** back to your buddy.
- **Colour:** Blue or Pink.
- **Tamagotchi:** On or Off (Chapter 2).
- **Quit:** closes Buddy.

Tamagotchi 2

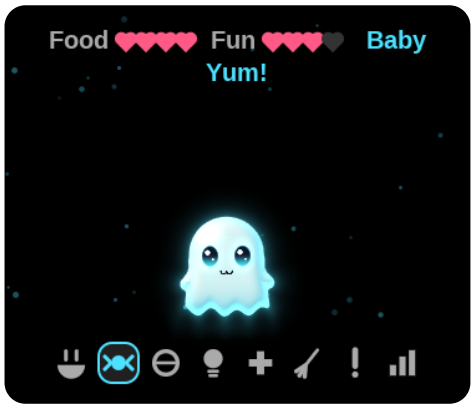
Raise your buddy from an egg.

Hatching an egg

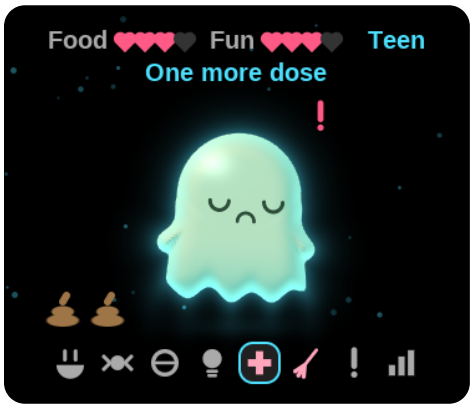
Open the menu and set **Tamagotchi: On**. You start with an egg. Your buddy lives in real time, whether Buddy is open or closed. Turn Tamagotchi off to stop its clock; the toy from Chapter 1 is back until you turn it on again.

Looking after it

The wheel moves along the icons, and Centre or a tap uses one. An icon that pulses pink, with a **!** over your buddy, is something it needs. You can still pet it and poke it for fun; a pet is worth a heart of Fun, once every ten minutes. Centre doesn't say boo here.



Fed



Sick, with a mess to clean

Icon	Does this
Bowl	Meal: a heart of Food, and a little weight. It refuses when full
Sweet	Snack: a heart of Fun, and more weight. Too heavy and it can get sick
Ball	The game: guess which way it turns, with the wheel or a tap on that side. Win three of five for a heart of Fun; either way it loses a little weight
Bulb	Lights: when it's tired, put it to bed. It sleeps faster in the dark, and if you wake it early it sulks
Cross	Medicine: two doses when it looks green
Broom	Clean up. Left lying around, the mess can make it sick
!	Scold: when it pulls a face and refuses food or the game for no reason. That builds discipline; scolding it otherwise only hurts its feelings
Bars	Its age, weight, discipline and which egg this is

Growing up

Hatched, it grows from Baby to Child after an hour, to Teen after a day and to Adult after three.

A need left unanswered for an hour is one care mistake. An Adult raised with at most one mistake and 50% discipline wears a halo; one with five or more grows horns. Starving or sick for about three days awake, it floats away, and Centre brings the next egg.

Your Own Buddy 3

Paint your own, and Buddy shows it instead of the ghost.

What you need

- Buddy installed on the Q2, so the card has its `.fidget` folder.
- A computer and the Q2's USB-C cable.
- An image editor that keeps see-through areas. GIMP is free for Windows, macOS and Linux, and Photopea is free in a web browser. The steps here use GIMP.

Paint it

Your buddy is one picture holding all its looks, in two rows of seven squares.

1. Download the template, buddy-template.png (github.com/DiamondBond/q2-fidget/raw/main/buddy-template.png). It's the ghost itself, in every look.
2. Open it in your editor. **Don't resize or crop it:** it has to stay 1344 x 384 pixels.
3. Turn on a grid so you can see the squares. In GIMP: **Image** → **Configure Grid**, set the spacing to 192 by 192, then **View** → **Show Grid**.
4. Paint over the squares you want to change. Any square you leave alone stays the ghost, so you can start with just a few. The fourteen squares shows which is which.
5. Where you want nothing, erase to see-through, not to white. To empty a whole square in GIMP, select it with the Rectangle Select tool and press Delete. See-through areas show the screen behind, and soft edges blend.
6. Keep each look inside its square, and about the ghost's size. A point 96 pixels across and 112 down from the square's top-left corner is your buddy's middle, where it floats, turns and squashes.
7. In GIMP choose **File** → **Export As**, name it `buddy.png` and press Export. Leave **Interlacing** off and the other options as they are. **Save** on its own makes a `.xcf` file, which Buddy can't read.

> **Only have one picture?** Empty squares 1 to 11, paste it into each one, centred, and export. Its face won't change with its mood, but it will still hop, squash and fly.

The fourteen squares



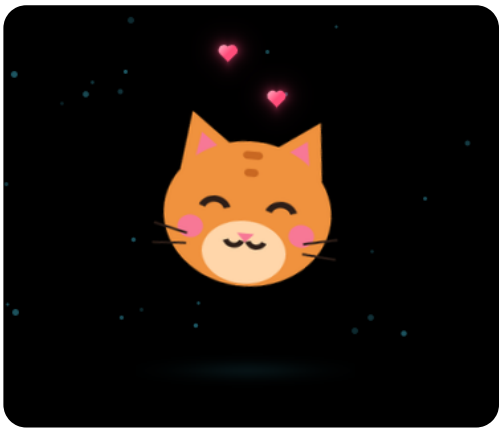
The template, with its squares numbered

Square	Shows when
1 Normal	Most of the time
2 Blink	For a moment, every few seconds
3 Happy	Giggling, booped, let go after a fling, fed
4 Petted	While you pet it
5 Surprised	Picked up, just booped, woken
6 Annoyed	Annoyed, refusing or scolded, and acting up in Tamagotchi
7 Boo	Saying boo
8 Dizzy	Dizzy
9 Asleep	Dozing, or in bed
10 Sad	Hungry or bored, in Tamagotchi
11 Sick	Sick, in Tamagotchi; Buddy tints it green
12 Egg	Before it hatches
13 Halo	Over an Adult raised with care, on its face's square
14 Horns	Over an Adult raised with five or more mistakes

Baby to Adult use the same squares, drawn smaller.

Put it on the Q2

1. On the Q2, close Buddy: hold **Return**. It reads your picture as it opens, and a game should be closed before you plug in USB.
2. Plug the Q2 into your computer with the USB-C cable. The card shows up as a drive.
3. Open the `.fidget` folder at the top of the card. Its leading dot hides it on a Mac (press Cmd+Shift+. in Finder) and on Linux (press Ctrl+H in the file manager).
4. Copy `buddy.png` into `.fidget`, beside the file called `q2-fidget`.
5. Eject the card on your computer, then unplug the Q2.
6. Open **Library** → **Games** → **Buddy**.



Your own buddy, being petted

It hops, squashes, tilts and flies as the ghost does, but has no waving arms, rippling hem or eyes that follow your finger, and no glow unless you paint one. A tap above its middle boops it; lower down, it giggles. **Colour** recolours the sparkles and menus, not your painting.

If you still see the ghost

A file Buddy can't use leaves the ghost, with a line across the top for a few seconds saying why:



What a problem looks like

The line says	What to do
buddy.png isn't 1344 x 384	The picture was resized or cropped. Paint on a fresh copy of the template
buddy.png is interlaced	Export it again with Interlacing off
Save buddy.png as 8-bit	It's 16-bit. In GIMP choose **Image** → **Precision**, pick 8 bit integer, and export it again
buddy.png isn't a PNG	Renaming a file doesn't convert it. Export it from your editor as a PNG
buddy.png is too big	It's 3 MB or more. Check its size is 1344 x 384, and export it again without extra data such as a thumbnail or colour profile
buddy.png is damaged	Copy it to the card again, and eject before you unplug

The ghost with no line at all means Buddy didn't find the file:

- It must be named exactly `buddy.png`. Windows can hide the ending, so it may really be `buddy.png.png`: turn on File name extensions in File Explorer's View menu.
- It must be inside `.fidget`, not at the top of the card or in another folder.
- Buddy reads it only as it opens, so close Buddy and open it again.

Changing it, or going back

To change your buddy, copy a new `buddy.png` over the old one. To go back to the ghost, delete it. Then open Buddy again.

Updates keep your picture, but removing Buddy in the App Store deletes it with the folder, so keep a copy on your computer.

Updating and Help 4

Keep Buddy up to date, and find out what went wrong.

Updating and removing

To update, press Centre on Buddy's **Update** row in **System settings** → **App Store**, or unzip a newer release over it. Your pet, its colour and your `buddy.png` stay.

To remove it, press Buddy's **Installed** row in the App Store twice, or delete the `.fidget` folder. Either way your pet and `buddy.png` go with it.

Troubleshooting

- **Buddy isn't in Library → Games:** it isn't installed, or it's in the wrong place. The card needs a `.fidget` folder at its top level, with `q2-fidget` and `q2app` inside.
- **It closes by itself:** two minutes without a touch closes it. **Smart Awake** keeps it open.
- **Your pet is gone:** starving or sick for about three days awake, it floats away. Centre brings the next egg.
- **Your picture doesn't show:** see If you still see the ghost.

> **Getting help:** report a problem at github.com/DiamondBond/q2-fidget/issues, with what you did and what happened. If it's about your own buddy, attach your `buddy.png`.

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